MIL-C-36185A
9 March 1978
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-36185 (DM)
16 March 1964

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

COVER, PILLOW, PLASTIC

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers plastic pillow covers, suitable for use in medical facilities.

1.2 Classification. Pillow covers shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I	- 31 x 19 inches
Type II	- 29 x 22 inches

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-375	- Plastic Film, Flexible, Vinyl Chloride.
V-F-106	- Fasteners, Slide, Interlocking.
PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Setup.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 7210

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-TEST-METHOD-STD.-NO. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING & MATERIALS (ASTM)

D-1433 - Flammability of Flexible Thin Plastic Sheeting.
D-882 - Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing & Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The United States Pharmacopeia (USP)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the procurement document, the contractor shall furnish sample unit(s) for first article inspection (see 4.1.2.1 and 6.2).

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Sheeting.

3.2.1.1 Polyvinyl chloride. Polyvinyl chloride sheeting shall be a flexible, non-toxic vinyl chloride plastic, 0.004 inch ± 10 percent thick and conforming to type I, class 1 of L-P-375 and 3.2.1.3, 3.2.1.4 and 3.4.

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3.2.1.2 Vinyl-nylon laminate. As an alternate, vinyl-nylon laminate may be used for sheeting. Laminate shall be made from nylon yarn, laminated on both sides with a plasticized vinyl-chloride polymer coating. Laminate shall be moisture-repellant, non-toxic, and anti-bacterial; shall have a weight of 6.2 ounces per square yard, ± 10%, and a tensile strength of not less than 65 pounds per linear inch in both the machine and fill directions. Laminate shall be white in color and shall conform to 3.2.1.3 and 3.2.1.4.

3.2.1.3 Flammability. The sheeting shall be internally treated with flame retardant material and shall not support combustion when tested as specified in 4.5.1. A translucent or milky white appearance resulting from the addition of the flame retardant material shall be acceptable.

3.2.1.4 Stain resistance. The sheeting shall show no effects, other than slight discoloration, from blood, saliva, oil, grease, alcohol, and perspiration, when tested as specified in 4.5.2.

3.2.2 Slide fastener. The slide fastener shall conform to V-F-106 for type I, style 6, size L, single slider, long tab pull, aluminum chain. The pull, slider, bridge stop, and bottom stop shall be made from brass and plated with either nickel or nickel-silver. The tape for the slide fastener shall be white cotton tape, impregnated with vinyl chloride plastic on the pull side. The slide fastener with tape shall also conform to the requirement for resistance to boiling water as specified in 3.4.

3.3 Design and construction. The design and construction of the pillow cover shall conform to figure 1 and as specified herein.

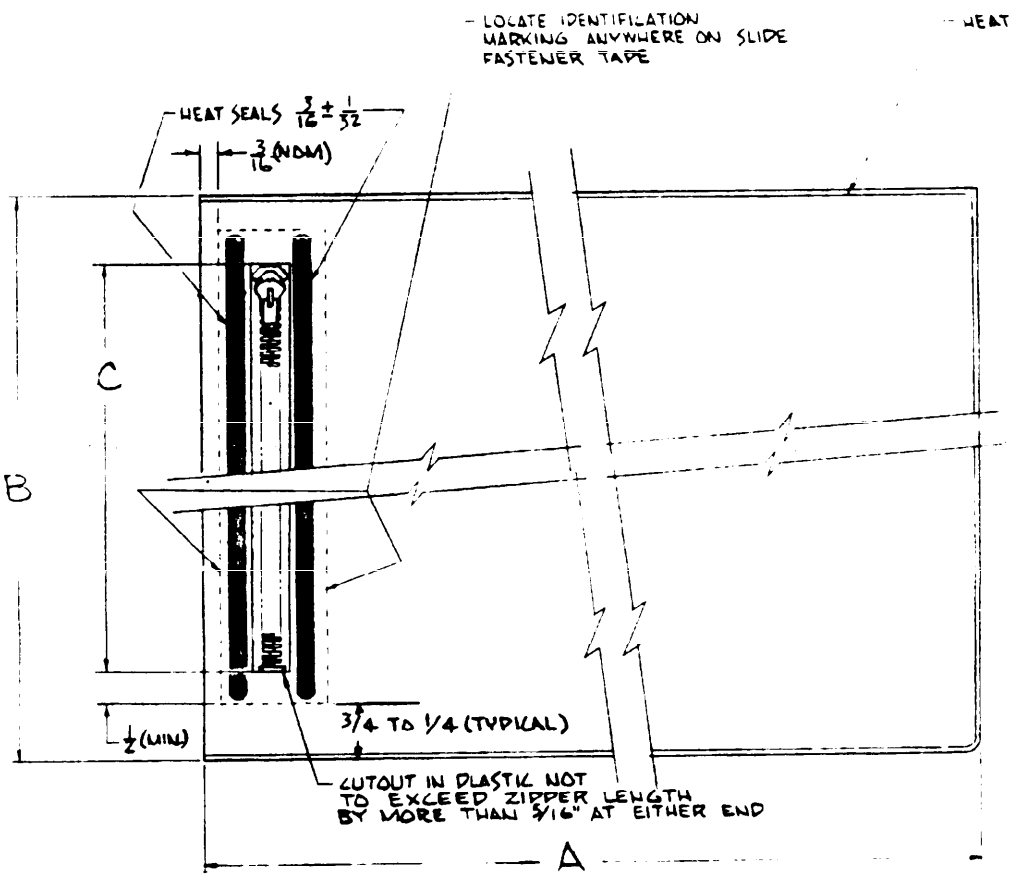
3.3.1 Cover construction. The pillow cover shall consist of either one or two panels of sheeting. When one panel of sheeting is used, the panel shall be folded along one edge and then completely heat sealed along the other three edges. When two panels of sheeting are used, one panel shall be superimposed upon the other and the entire perimeter of the panels shall be heat sealed together. As an alternate, pillows made of vinyl-nylon laminate may be stitched.

3.3.2 Slide fastener attachment. The slide fastener shall be the length specified in figure 1 and the slide fastener tape shall be attached to the inside of the cover by means of electronic heat seal. In the case of vinyl-nylon laminate covers, slide fastener may be attached by stitching.

3.3.3 Heat seals. All heat seals shall be continuous, uniform, and neatly made and shall not weaken the basic material. The width of each heat seal shall be as specified in figure 1. The strength of the bond shall be not less than 65 percent of the tensile strength of the sheeting when tested as specified in 4.5.3.1.

3.3.4 Stitched seams. Seams shall be stitched with a minimum of 5 stitches per inch, using a suitable cotton or synthetic thread. Stitched seams, including the slide fastener attachment, shall have a tensile strength of at least 20 pounds per linear inch when tested as specified in 4.5.3.2. Seams shall be straight and uniform, and made so that edges of the sheeting are on the inside of the finished cover.

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DIM.	TYPE I	TYPE II
A	31 - 1/2 - 1	29 1/4 ± 1/2
B	19 - 1/2 - 1/4	17 1/4 ± 1/4
C	- - 1/8 - 3/8	9 1/4 ± 1/4

NOTES:
1. FOR ONE-PIECE CONSTRUCTION FOLD ONE END, HEAT SEAL TWO SIDES AND OTHER END.
2. FOR TWO-PIECE CONSTRUCTION HEAT SEAL ENTIRE PERIMETER.
3. ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES

FIGURE 1. Pillow cover.

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3.4 Resistance to boiling water. The polyvinyl-chloride sheeting and slide fastener tape shall not become brittle or sticky and the slide fastener shall remain operative when the cover is tested as specified in 4.5.4.

3.5 Identification marking. Each pillow cover shall be permanently and legibly marked with the National Stock Number (6.4) and the contract or purchase order number. Marking shall be applied by the heat method on the slide fastener tape.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The finished pillow cover shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or may impair its serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2.1 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection.
b. Quality conformance inspection.

4.1.2.1.1 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on covers when a first article sample is required (see 3.1). This inspection shall include examination of 4.4 and tests of 4.5.

4.1.2.1.2 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall include the examination of 4.4 and tests of 4.5.

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4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the materials may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government and provided also that the test methods and the results obtained comply with those described in this specification. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Inspection lot.

4.2.1 Raw materials. An inspection lot for raw material inspection shall be all material produced under the same conditions and controlled to the degree that uniformity of product within the designated lot can be assured. Lot identification of the raw material by the manufacturer is one method of control, as cited above, which is considered acceptable.

4.2.2 End product. An inspection lot for inspection of end product shall consist of all covers of the same type produced under essentially the same conditions and offered for inspection at one time.

4.3 Sampling.

4.3.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table I. The unit of product for examination shall be one cover.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

	Inspection level	AQL (defects per hundred units)
For visual examination		
Major defects	I	2.5
Total (major and minor combined)	I	6.5
For dimensional examination	S-3	6.5

4.3.2 For tests.

4.3.2.1 Sheeting. Samples of the material used in the fabrication of the pillow covers shall be selected for testing in accordance with table II. Two samples, randomly selected, shall be tested from each lot (4.2) of sheeting used in the manufacture of the cover. The dimensions of test samples (where required) shall be as specified in the test method. The acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.

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TABLE II. Sampling of sheeting.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test method
Flammability	3.2.1.3	4.5.1
Stain resistance		
to Blood	3.2.1.4	4.5.2.1
to Saliva	3.2.1.4	4.5.2.2
to Oil	3.2.1.4	4.5.2.3
to Grease	3.2.1.4	4.5.2.4
to Alcohol	3.2.1.4	4.5.2.5
to Perspiration (alkaline and acidic)	3.2.1.4	4.5.2.6

4.3.2.2 Cover. Sampling for tests of the finished pillow cover shall be conducted in accordance with table III and MIL-STD-105 for an inspection level of S-1. The acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.

TABLE III. Sampling of pillow cover.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test method
Bond strength of seams	3.3.3, 3.3.4	4.5.3.1, 4.5.3.2
Resistance to boiling water (polyvinyl-chloride covers only)	3.4	4.5.4

4.4 Examination. The pillow covers shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.4.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the classification of defects listed in table IV. Examination shall not be limited to the classified possible defects listed below.

TABLE IV. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major:	
101	Material other than specified.
102	Component missing.
103	Bubble, sharp crease, wrinkle, blister, gouge, cut, tear, hole, break, crack or other imperfection present in sheeting material.
104	Patch, splice or repair present in sheeting material.
105	Slide fastener does not function properly or binds, catches or sticks at any point.
106	Slide fastener scoop is improperly mated or does not mesh with its corresponding scoops when chain is in closed position.
107	Slider goes beyond stop.

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects. (Continued)

Categories	Defects
108	Slider disengages from either row of scoops.
109	Slide fastener metal parts (excluding chain) not nickel plated or nickel-silver plated.
110	Metal part fractured, split or broken.
111	Sharp burr, splinter, sharp fin or sharp edge is present.
112	Slide pull becomes detached during operation.
113	Slide fastener tape not impregnated with vinyl chloride plastic on the pull side; slide fastener tape not attached on inside of cover, inadequately sealed, or reversed (i.e., pull is on inside of cover).
114	Heat seal or stitched seam not present or not complete.
115	Cover not constructed as specified.
Minor:	
201	Vinyl-nylon laminate not white in color.
202	Vinyl-chloride plastic material not uniformly colorless (Note: Slight pigmentation will be permitted to neutralize any natural yellow tint or to achieve flame retardancy).
203	Objectional odor.
204	Finish of metal other than specified.
205	Finish of metal is mottled, tarnished, stained, scaly, peeling, or blistered.
206	Seam puckered, distorted, misplaced, out of alignment or not on a straight plane by more than 1/4 inch.
207	Foreign matter or material imbedded in the sheeting.
208	Cover stained or not clean.
209	Identification marking omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, or misplaced.
210	Identification marking applied by other than heat method.

4.4.2 Dimensional examination. The pillow covers shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerances specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.5.1 Flammability.

4.5.1.1 Vinyl-chloride. The flammability of the plastic sheeting shall be tested as specified in ASTM D1433. "Will not support combustion" shall be defined, for this specification, as the flame going out before it has reached the second thread (before it has traveled six inches).

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4.5.1.2 Vinyl-nylon laminate. The flammability of the vinyl-nylon laminate shall be tested as specified in Method 5903 of FED-TEST-METHOD-STD No. 191. "Will not support combustion" shall be defined, for this specification, as the char length not exceeding 6 inches.

4.5.2 Stain resistance.

4.5.2.1 To blood. Pour 5 millilitres (ml) of blood (human, warm-blooded animal, or fowl) on a specimen of plastic sheeting 12 inches square. Spread the blood to a thin even layer. After drying, the dried blood shall be allowed to remain in contact with the plastic film for 24 hours. The specimen shall then be washed off with a cloth or sponge using soap and water. Observe for stains or discoloration.

4.5.2.2 To saliva. Use the same method as specified in 4.5.2.1, except that human saliva shall be substituted for the blood.

4.5.2.3 To oil. Pour 5 ml of light mineral oil, USP, or castor oil, USP, on a specimen of plastic sheeting 12 inches square. Spread the oil to a thin layer. Allow the oil to remain in contact with the plastic film for 24 hours. The specimen shall then be washed off with a cloth or sponge using soap and water. Observe for stains or discoloration.

4.5.2.4 To grease. Use the same method as specified in 4.5.2.3, except that 5 grams of petrolatum shall be substituted for the oil.

4.5.2.5 To alcohol. Pour 5 ml of rubbing isopropyl alcohol or 70 percent ethyl alcohol on a specimen of plastic sheeting 12 inches square. Spread to a thin layer. Permit the alcohol to evaporate at room temperature. Repeat the procedure every half hour for 4 hours. After 4 hours, wash with a cloth or sponge using soap and water. Observe for stains or discoloration.

4.5.2.6 To perspiration. Pour 5 ml of acid solution, as specified in method 5682 of FED-TEST-METHOD-STD 191, on a specimen of plastic sheeting 12 inches square. Spread the solution to a thin layer. After drying, allow the residue to remain in contact with the plastic film for 24 hours. Wash off with a cloth or sponge using soap and water. Observe for stains or discoloration. Repeat the test using the alkaline solution as specified in method 5682 of FED-TEST-METHOD-STD NO. 191.

4.5.3 Strength of seams.

4.5.3.1 Heat sealed seams. The bond strength of the heat sealed seams shall be determined as specified in ASTM D-882, except that tests shall be performed on one seam per cover. The seam specimen to be tested shall be 1 inch wide and shall be cut from any point along the seam. For breaking (bonding) strength of the bonded seam, the seam shall be at the center of the specimen and perpendicular to the center line. The free ends of the specimen shall be gripped (one in each jaw) in the testing machine.

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4.5.3.2 Stitched seams. The strength of the stitched seams shall be determined as specified in method 5110 of FED-TEST-METHOD-STD NO. 191.

4.5.4 Resistance to boiling water. Vinyl-chloride pillow cover shall be placed in boiling water for 6 hours.

4.6 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit packaging, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One cover, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. Each cover, with slide fastener closed, shall be neatly folded in such a manner that when packaged, the slide fastener and scoop will be located at one end of the package and adjacent to the inner faces of the container. A strip of pressure-sensitive tape or other suitable cushioning material which can be easily removed without damage to the plastic shall be placed between the slide fastener and the plastic to prevent damage to the back panel. Each folded cover shall be inserted into a kraft paper or plastic bag of a suitable size and design. Closure of the bag shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2.2 Intermediate package. Twelve unit packages shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure of the box shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. Each cover shall be neatly folded and packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Twelve intermediate packages (144 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve intermediate (144 units) packages shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

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5.2.3 Level C. The packaged covers shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the applicable carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and intermediate package shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior containers shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The plastic pillow cover is intended to protect pillows from soilage. Type I is intended for use with pillow, NSN 7210-00-716-7000 and Type II is intended for use with pillow NSN 7210-00-119-5358.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c. Type required (see 1.2).
d. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.1.2.1 and 6.3).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be tested under the appropriate provisions of the Armed Services Procurement Regulations. The contract or purchase order specifies the quantity, procedure for delivery and other specific instructions for inspection of the first article.

6.4 This specification covers the following items:

National Stock Number	Item Identification	Type
7210-00-715-9200	COVER, PILLOW, PLASTIC	I, 31 x 19 inches
7210-01-023-5026	COVER, PILLOW, PLASTIC	II, 29 x 22 inches

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activity:
DoD - MB

Preparing activity:
DLA-DM

Project No. 7210-0224

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MIL-C-36185A COVER, PILLOW, PLASTIC

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